

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 7 5 4

♥ -

♦ T 9 6 2

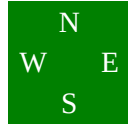
♣ T 6 4 3

♠ 6

♥ A Q J 9 8

♦ A K 8 5

♣ K Q J



♠ Q J 9 3

♥ T 6 4 3

♦ Q J

♣ 8 5 2

♠ A T 2

♥ K 7 5 2

♦ 7 4 3

♣ A 9 7

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

You dealt this hand.

This is a big hand. But not quite enough to open 2♣. So you open 1♥ and partner responds 3♥. Now what?

You might bid 4♦ as a slam try, but it is probably just as well to go ahead and ask for Aces. So you bid 4NT and partner owns up to holding 2 Aces. What is your next bid?

You have all the Aces but don't go crazy. Partner only has 11-12 points so don't think too Grand! Bid 6♥.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

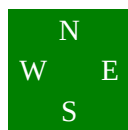
♠ 9 8 7  
♥ T 8 6  
♦ A Q 8 5  
♣ 6 3 2

♠ A Q J 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ T 4 2

♣ J 5 4



♠ K 5  
♥ A K Q 7 5  
♦ K 6 3  
♣ A T 8

♠ T 4 3 2

♥ J 2

♦ J 9 7

♣ K Q 9 7

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

4♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

The bidding has been as shown.

With 6 points you must respond and you should let partner know you have support for his suit. So you bid 2♥ and he promptly raises to 4♥. It's a good thing he had 20 points isn't it.

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K J T 6 5

♥ A

♦ T 9 3

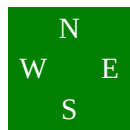
♣ J T 7

♠ 8

♥ Q 9 8 5 3

♦ K J 8 5

♣ 8 6 4



♠ Q 9 3

♥ J 6

♦ 7 6 2

♣ A Q 9 5 2

♠ 7 4 2

♥ K T 7 4 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ K 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

1♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

When you have a weak, distributional hand with 5 of partner's suit an immediate jump to game is usually the best approach. If he has a good hand you will probably make the contract. If he is minimum then you might get a preemptive effect and stop your LHO from entering the bidding.

This is a good example. Partner may be lucky and make 4♥. But if they had had an opportunity to compete the opponents might well be able to make 4♠.

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 3  
 ♥ A K J 8 7 3  
 ♦ A Q J 3  
 ♣ 7 3

♠ Q 8 4

♥ 4 2

♦ K 9 8 6

♣ Q J 9 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A K 9 7 2

♥ Q 5

♦ 7 4 2

♣ T 6 5

♠ J T 6 5

♥ T 9 6

♦ T 5

♣ A K 8 4

West

1♥

3♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

North

Pass

Pass

East

1♠

4♥

South

Pass

The bidding has been as shown.

You can't support partner's ♥s with only 2 of them so you bid your nice ♠ suit. Partner then jumps to 3♥. Now

Here's where a lot of players go wrong. Since they only promised 4 ♠s with their first response they think they should now rebid them to show partner they had 5. And this **MIGHT** work if it turns out partner has 3 ♠s. Not only is this a risky bid, it is unnecessary. When partner jump rebid ♥s he showed 16-18 points and 6 ♥s. So you know of an 8-card fit and you know you should be in game. Bid 4♥.

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

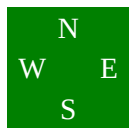
♠ 8 4  
♥ K J 4 3  
♦ T 8 6  
♣ 9 7 3 2

♠ A Q T 9 3

♥ A 9 2

♦ K Q J 3

♣ 4



♠ 6 5  
♥ Q T 7 6  
♦ A 9 5  
♣ J T 8 6

♠ K J 7 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A K Q 5

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♣   |
| Pass         | 2 ♦   | Pass | 4 ♠   |
| Pass         | 4NT   | Pass | 5 ♦   |
| Pass         | 6 ♠   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6 ♠ by North |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

As soon as partner opens 1 ♠ you know you will settle for nothing less than the ♠ game. The problem with bidding 4 ♠ right now is that partner will take you for the "weak-distributional-with-five-trumps" hand. So you temporize by first bidding 2 ♣. Partner rebids 2 ♦.

You now jump to 4 ♠, completing the picture of an opening hand with good ♠ support. Partner bids 4NT. What say you?

This is Blackwood so you answer 5 ♦ for one Ace. Partner says 6 ♠.